

Rafiul Ahmed

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LinkedIn — Website — Github — Google Scholar

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Energy Economics, Environmental & Resource Economics, and Public Policy

Subfields: Renewable Energy Transitions, Energy Infrastructure Policy & Siting, Energy Access & Development, Policy Evaluation, Applied Microeconomics

EDUCATION

University of Maine

Sept 2024 – May 2026

M.S. in Economics (Applied Economics concentration)

CGPA: 3.8/ 4.0 (Completed with Outstanding International Graduate Student Award 2024-25)

Shahjalal University of Science and Technology, Sylhet

Feb 2018 – Feb 2023

B.S.S. in Economics

CGPA: 3.8/ 4.0 (Completed with academic distinction *Magna cum Laude*)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

UMaine School of Economics

Dec 2024 – May 2026

Graduate Research Assistant

Experimental Environmental Economics & PFAS Contamination: Conducting experimental research on how people interpret and respond to PFAS contamination, focusing on public awareness, risk perception, and behavioral impacts on rural resilience and Maine's food systems.

Marine Aquaculture Market Analysis: Contributing to research aimed at expanding market opportunities for Maine's marine aquaculture industry by prioritizing supply chain analysis, identifying seafood market barriers, and analyzing consumer preferences to inform policy and industry strategy.

Key Responsibilities:

- Assisting in designing, conducting, and analyzing controlled experiments and studies.
- Collaborating with faculty and research teams on manuscript preparation for peer-reviewed journals.
- Supporting grant-funded research, including literature reviews, technical report writing, and compliance.
- Preparing and delivering research presentations for academic conferences and stakeholder workshops.

Municipal Project Analyst

Jan 2025- May 2025

Service-Learning Project, Bethel Energy Conservation Committee
Town of Bethel, ME

Completed a semester-long service-learning engagement with the Town of Bethel, Maine, contributing a cost-benefit analysis to inform a five-year municipal sustainable energy and efficiency plan.

Key Contributions:

- Consolidated electricity and heating data for six municipal facilities into energy baselines and load profiles.
- Co-led a solar PV feasibility assessment paired with a cost-benefit analysis framework accessible to non-technical stakeholders.
- Developed a dual-track plan integrating phased solar adoption and targeted efficiency measures, with explicit sequencing guidance (weatherization before electrification; aligning solar with equipment replacement cycles).
- Produced public-facing materials and presented findings at Town Hall, incorporating stakeholder feedback into final deliverables.

South Asian Network on Economic Modeling (SANEM)

Feb 2023 – May 2024

Senior Research Assistant

Dhaka, Bangladesh

Key Responsibilities:

- Authored and managed project proposals for diverse stakeholders, including international foundations, donor agencies, and government representatives.
- Analyzed and interpreted data and wrote research reports.
- Designed questionnaires and conducted FGDs, KIIs, and IDIs for multiple projects.
- Managed survey operations with field enumerators.
- Collected, analyzed, and presented relevant data for research outputs.

Project involvement with the **United Nations Development Program (UNDP)**, **World Bank**, **Asian Development Bank (ADB)**, **International Labor Organization (ILO)**

SUST Research Center

Jul 2022 – Dec 2022

Undergraduate Research Assistant (Contractual)

Sylhet, Bangladesh

Worked on a funded project that examined the impact of poverty on cognitive development in farmers in Sunamganj, Sylhet, under the supervision of Md. Gias Uddin Khan and Dr. M.A.H. Pradhan.

Key responsibilities included survey design (including KII, FGD, IDI), fieldwork coordination, data analysis, literature review, and drafting research chapters.

South Asian Network on Economic Modeling (SANEM)

Nov 2021 – Dec 2022

Research Intern

Dhaka, Bangladesh

Working as a Research Intern, I assisted in data analysis, literature reviews, and the preparation of research reports and policy briefs on development and labor market issues in South Asia.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

UMaine School of Economics

Sept 2024 – Dec 2024

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Fall 2024:

- ECO 220 - Intermediate Microeconomics
- ECO 403/503 - Experimental Economics

RESEARCH PUBLICATIONS

Peer Reviewed Articles.

- Godin, M. J., Noblet, C. L., Furtado, C. H., **Ahmed M.R.**, Kopec, A. D.(2026). Tradition in transition: Fishing, hunting, and food security in a changing Maine. *Maine Policy Review*, 34(2). [Article]

Work Under Review.

- **Ahmed, M.R.**, Uyar, M., Evans,K.S., Noblet, C.L., (2025). Perceptions, Preferences, and Barriers: Insights into U.S. Seafood Consumption Behavior. *Aquaculture Economics & Management*

Technical Reports.

- Noblet, C. L., Kopec, D., Godin, M., **Ahmed, R.**, Amegbor, G., Shea, M., Furtado, C., Penlington, P., & LaForge, B. (2025, September). Assessing Maine's Anglers' Preferences for Fish Consumption". Maine Department of Inland Fisheries and Wildlife, Fisheries & Hatcheries Bureau.

- Raihan, S., Bidisha, S. H., Ahmed, M. T., Hossain, I., Chowdhury, O. R., Asaduzzaman, M., Surid, T. F., & **Ahmed, M. R.** (2024). An Analysis of the Power and Energy Sector in the FY2023–24 National Budget. *SANEM Publications*, Dhaka, Bangladesh

Conferences Presentations.

- **Ahmed, M. R.**, Uyar, M., Noblet, C. L., & Evans, K. S. (2025). From Tourist to Trusted Consumer: Maine Visitation's Impact on Seafood Consumption, Barrier Quality Ratings *Aquaculture America 2026*, Las Vegas, NV, United States. [Poster]
- Uyar, M., **Ahmed, M. R.**, Noblet, C. L., & Evans, K. S. (2025). Tapping into Unmet Demand for U.S. Seafood: Can Maine Lead the Way? *Maine Blue Economy Innovation Summit 2025*, Portland, ME, United States. [Poster]
- **Ahmed, M. R.**, Noblet, C. L., & Evans, K. S. (2025). Reeling in the facts: How do US consumers view seafood quality and the marine environment *UMaine Student Symposium*, Orono, ME, United States. [Poster]
- Khan, G. U., **Ahmed, M. R.**, & Shaid, A. (2023). Does poverty hinder cognitive development? An empirical study from Sylhet *SANEM 6th Annual Economists' Conference*, Dhaka, Bangladesh. [Conference Paper]

Op-ed/Analytical Feature.

- Aahad, A., **Ahmed, R.** (2024, March 15). *Miles to go to develop a healthier Bangladesh*. The Business Standard. [Article]
- Das, D., **Ahmed, R.** (2023). *Women's career aspirations, role in the workforce, and pay gap: Nobel Prize in Economics 2023*. Thinking Aloud, 10 (7). [Article]
- Raihan, S., Sharmin, E., Das, P., **Ahmed, R.** (2023) . *Towards a Women Financial Inclusion Strategy of Bangladesh (WFIS-B)*. Thinking Aloud, 10(5). [Article]

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Technical Skills: R, STATA, MATLAB, Tableau, Power BI, ArcGIS, QGIS

Typesetting: Overleaf (LaTeX), MS Office, Google Suite

Data Science & Analytics Technologies: Data Science Pipeline (Cleansing, Wrangling, Visualization, Modeling, Interpretation), Applied Statistics, Hypothesis Testing, Time Series Econometrics (Forecasting, Regression Analysis), Spatial Data Analysis (GIS Mapping, Remote Sensing Data Processing)

Survey Design and Management: Google Forms, Qualtrics, Kobo Toolbox, Survey CTO

LEADERSHIP AND VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCES

- President, *UMaine School of Economics Graduate Student Club (Jul 2025 – Jun 2026)*
- Vice-President, *UMaine Bangladesh Student Association (Sep 2024 - Aug 2025)*
- Founder and Executive Director, *Econ Insider (Apr 2020 – Apr 2022)*
- Branding and Communication Secretary, *SUST Economic Association (Jul 2019 – Jul 2020)*
- Executive Member, *Bangladesh Economics Students Network (Oct 2019 – Oct 2020)*

CERTIFIED LICENSES

- IRB Member (Jan 2025), CITI Program
- Social and Behavioral Research (Jan 2025), CITI Program

AWARDS & HONORS

- Roger D. Coopman Outstanding International Graduate Student Scholarship 2024-25 & 2025-26, School of Economics, University of Maine
- Charles H. and Katherine C. Merchant Scholarship 2025-26, University of Maine
- Semifinalist National Blockchain Olympiad 2022, Bangladesh
- Participated in 18 business and policy case competitions and secured multiple achievements.
- Best Science Project in STEM Fair 2016 by U.S. Department of State and Notre Dame College